

Chapter 52-1

Liang Shi stood in place, drinking from the water that the staff had handed her. Qi Taitai¹ had already stepped over on her high heels.

Ten-centimeter green strappy high heels polished to a shine, perfectly matching the qipao² she wore.

She seemed particularly fond of wearing qipaos. Every time Liang Shi had seen her, she was dressed in a qipao.

Including in that memory.

She walked neither hurriedly nor slowly, each step swaying gracefully, like a lotus blooming in a river, swaying in the wind.

Without a doubt, she was very beautiful, well-maintained, and had a figure perfectly suited for qipaos.

But for Liang Shi, her very existence was oppressive.

Before she had even approached, Liang Shi could feel her heart pounding wildly in her chest, her mind filled with desperate thoughts of escape.

And the collision of high heels against the marble floor, click-clack, click-clack.

Could overlap perfectly with her memories.

Before she had even reached her, Liang Shi was already breaking out in cold sweat.

Liang Shi tried to convince herself in her heart: don't be afraid, there's nothing to fear, you've grown up now, she can't do anything to you.

But the fear emanating from deep within made her unable to stop shivering.

Zhao Ying also sensed something was wrong. As an actress, observing life and people was basic training.

Almost at a glance, she could tell there was something between Liang Shi and this investor's wife.

Zhao Ying stood up and walked to Liang Shi's side without hesitation, patting her arm, "Are you done filming?"

Only then did Liang Shi come back to her senses, gently exhaling, but when she tried to speak, she found her lips were still trembling.

This was a fear buried deep in her soul.

People say that an unfortunate childhood takes a lifetime to heal.

If it was a childhood of brutal abuse, then perhaps it could never be healed in a lifetime.

This kind of pain was embedded in the bones, something that could never be forgotten, occasionally emerging from the depths of memory to torment you, making you feel despair.

Liang Shi felt exactly like this now.

The moment she saw Qi Taitai, she couldn't help but tremble, shake, and want to flee.

Perhaps she wasn't as brave as she had been when encouraging Qi Jiao.

In this instant, she seemed to truly understand Qi Jiao.

Just like how the original body couldn't break free from Qiu Zimin's shackles, drifting like a wandering soul in the dark world Qiu Zimin had created for her.

Qi Jiao had lived under Qi Taitai's shadow from childhood to adulthood—how could she possibly muster the courage to resist?

This was completely unrealistic.

Fortunately, Zhao Ying was there. Her rationality returned somewhat, and she wasn't as afraid.

Liang Shi nodded in response to Zhao Ying: "Mm, I'm done."

Zhao Ying said: "Are you free later? I'll treat you to dinner."

Liang Shi immediately replied: "I'm free, but let me treat you instead."

If it weren't for Zhao Ying, she wouldn't have gotten the ticket to this role.

Just as her words fell, she heard a voice like opera singing: "I wonder if you'd mind adding me?"

It was Qi Taitai.

She always spoke in this tone. Liang Shi had once speculated about her profession.

But after searching for a lot of information online, she found nothing.

CEO Qi of Qida Company protected his wife and daughter's information extremely well—there was no information about them online.

She didn't even know the woman's name.

Hearing this, Liang Shi frowned, "We..."

She was about to refuse, but the director came over and immediately said: "Of course we don't mind. It's our honor that Qi Taitai is willing to have dinner with us."

Liang Shi's refusal was right on her lips—she couldn't swallow it, but she couldn't say it either.

But Zhao Ying was much more straightforward than her, laughing: "Then Director, you can eat with Qi Taitai. I'm taking Liang Shi out to eat. My cousin is there too, and she has social anxiety—she can't meet so many people."

Zhao Ying directly used Zhao Xuning as a shield.

And with a completely fabricated reason at that.

Footnotes: ¹ Qi Taitai: "Taitai" is a respectful form of address for a married woman, often used for the wife of someone important or wealthy ² Qipao: A traditional Chinese dress, also known as cheongsam, characterized by its form-fitting silhouette and high collar